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Basketball Applied Scientist Project

Why should we sign Dean Wade?

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Based on a comprehensive analysis of available free agent targets, I recommend signing Dean Wade. Quantitatively, Wade meets our criteria for a plus two-way contributor. In per-36 metrics, for the 2024-25 season, he demonstrates strong catch-and-shoot ability with 6.11 C&S 3-point attempts per 36 minutes, coupled with reliable defensive contributions averaging 7.5 defensive impact per 36 minutes, a metric calculated by combining a player's per-36 defensive tracking stats (defensive rebounds, steals, blocks, and defended field goal contributions (DFGM/DFGA)) into a single metric that captures their overall influence on the defensive end. Only players with sufficient defensive involvement were included to ensure the statistic reflects meaningful on-ball and help defense, rather than limited or low-usage minutes. This allows us to compare defensive contributions across players on an equal per-minute basis while standardizing for playing time. Moreover, Dean Wade's combined Total Impact metric ranks him among the top rotation-capable players within our salary range, highlighting his ability to provide meaningful contributions on both ends of the floor without commanding a prohibitive salary. Compared to alternatives like Georges Niang, Wade presents nearly equivalent two-way value while being significantly more affordable, fitting comfortably under our cap considerations.

	Player	Position	Age	Team	Salary	Signing_Likelihood	C&S_3PA_per_36	Defensive_Impact_per36	Total_Impact	Plus_Two_Way_Target
0	Georges Niang	PF	32.4	BOS	8500000.0	High	8.204651	5.7	13.904651	True
1	Dean Wade	PF	29.0	CLE	6166667.0	High	6.113208	7.5	13.613208	True

Beyond the numbers, qualitative evaluation of Wade's game further supports this recommendation. Reviewing game footage and highlights, he consistently demonstrates versatility in filling spots, moving off the ball, and knocking down three-pointers off late and strong closeouts. Notably, in one game last season, Wade scored 20 points in the fourth quarter alone including a game winner, showcasing his ability to contribute in high-leverage situations. His combination of floor spacing, defensive activity, and proven late-game effectiveness aligns with our team's strategic objectives and rotation needs.

In summary, Dean Wade represents a cost-efficient, high-upside option for our roster. He satisfies the thresholds established in our quantitative model for plus two-way players, while also providing practical skill sets observed in game film. Signing him offers a strong balance of affordability, offensive spacing, and defensive presence, making him a great candidate to reinforce the team's rotation and complement our core players.